

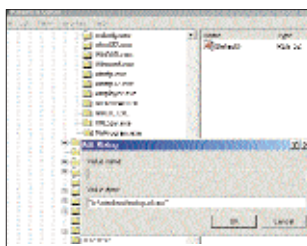
Windows XP Registry Tweaks

Warning: Tinkering with the Windows Registry isn't for the weak-hearted. Goofing off in this area can cause serious problems with your PC, so proceed with caution. We suggest turning on System Restore so that you can revert to the system state that existed before you did anything to the Registry.

Creating Program Aliases

Wouldn't you just love being able to start programs by just going to the Start > Run dialog and typing in the name? Here's how to do it:

1. Start the Registry Editor (Start > Run > "regedit")
2. Navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\App Paths and expand the tree—you'll find a lot of entries for different .exe files.
3. Right-click on App Paths and select New > Key and give it a name—MyProgram.exe, for example
4. Select this value, and in the right-hand pane, double-click on the "Default" value. Under Value Data, enter the path of the program—"c:\windows\notepad.exe",



for example

Now, when you go to Start > Run and type "MyProgram", the program you selected will come up.

Disable the expanding "New" menu in IE

Here's how you can change the File > New menu in IE and replace it with File > New Window.

1. Start the Registry Editor



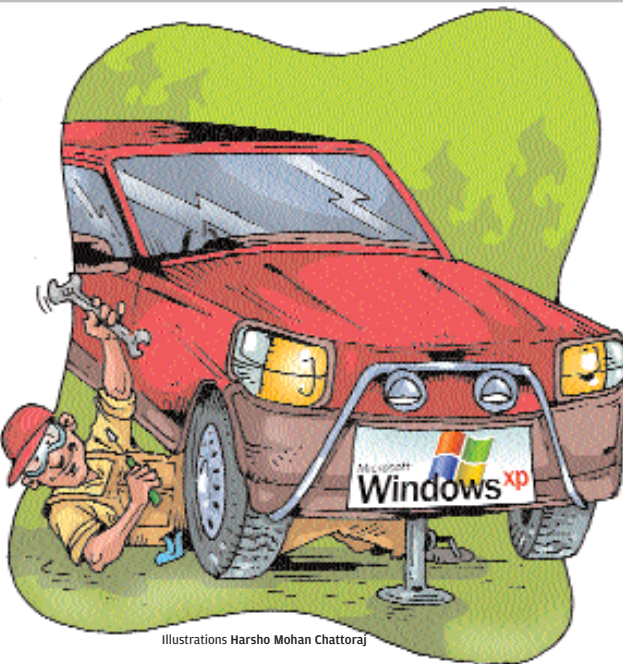
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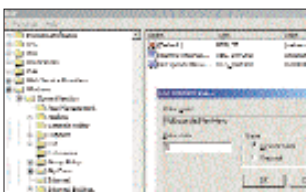
REGISTRY TWEAKS



Illustrations Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

(Start > Run > "regedit")

2. Navigate to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer
3. In the right-hand pane,

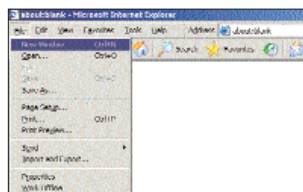


Set the DWORD value to 1

create a new DWORD (Right-click > New > DWORD Value) and call it

"NoExpandedNewMenu"

4. Double-click on this DWORD and set the Value



IE's new look!

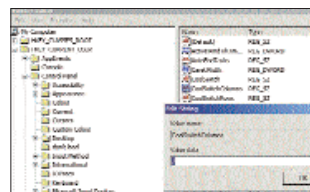
Data to 1

Your Internet Explorer should now show you only New Window under the File menu. You can always revert this setting by setting the value of the DWORD to 0.

Configure the [Alt] + [Tab] CoolSwitch

You can use the Registry to tweak the appearance of the CoolSwitch dialog that you see when you use [Alt] + [Tab] to switch between applications.

1. Start the Registry Editor (Start > Run > "regedit")
2. Navigate to HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Desktop
3. To enable or disable task switching altogether, modify the CoolSwitch value and set it to 1 or 0 respectively
4. To alter the appearance of the CoolSwitch dialog, modify the values of



Configuring the appearance of CoolSwitch

CoolSwitchColumns and CoolSwitchRows

Block Registry Tools

Warning: This tip blocks the Registry editing tools for *everyone*—Administrator included—so only use this if you're extremely paranoid about someone altering your registry. You will need third-party registry editors to get yourself out of this one.

1. Start the Registry Editor (Start > Run > "regedit")
2. Navigate to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System
3. In the right-hand pane, create a new DWORD value (Right-click > New > DWORD) and call it "DisableRegistryTools"
4. Double-click the DWORD and set the Value Data to 1
5. Restart Windows